



Stage 1 – Baseline Diagnostic & Cost-Aware Forecasting

 28 February 2026 | 11:00 AM

1. Executive Context

Lumina Energy operates a suburban Mumbai distribution zone.

Under Maharashtra's **Availability Based Tariff (ABT)** regulations, Power Distribution Companies must submit a **2-day ahead load forecast at 15-minute resolution** to the State Load Dispatch Centre (SLDC).

Deviation from submitted schedules attracts financial penalties.

Under ABT:

- Under-forecasting (Actual > Forecast) → costly grid drawal
- Over-forecasting (Forecast > Actual) → inefficiency + deviation charge
- Penalties are asymmetric
- Peak-hour deviations carry higher financial and operational risk

Forecast accuracy is no longer a statistical objective.

It is a **financial exposure minimization problem under regulatory constraint**.

You are engaged as the **Forecast Risk Advisory Team**.

2. Regulatory Simulation Framework

For Stage 1 simulation, assume:

Base Deviation Penalty Structure

Condition	Penalty
Actual > Forecast	₹4 per kWh deviation
Forecast > Actual	₹2 per kWh deviation

Peak Hour Definition

Peak Hours: **6:00 PM – 10:00 PM (local time)**

Peak deviations carry elevated system risk but follow base penalty rates in Stage 1.



3. Data Provided

A. Electric Load Data

- DateTime (15-minute intervals)
- Load (kW)
- Period: 1 April 2013 – 30 April 2021 (Training)

B. Weather Variables (15-minute aligned)

- Temperature
- Heat Index
- Humidity
- Rainfall
- Cool Factor

C. Event Data

- Date
- Event Name
- Holiday Indicator
- Remarks

Historical data includes structural disruptions.

Full stationarity should not be assumed.

External augmentation is permitted but must be documented.

4. Advisory Mandate

You must:

1. Develop a **2-day ahead load forecasting model** (15-min resolution).
2. Incorporate relevant exogenous drivers.
3. Quantify forecast uncertainty (intervals or quantiles).
4. Backtest historical deviation penalty exposure.
5. Propose a cost-minimizing forecast strategy.

Forecasting must minimize **expected financial penalty**, not merely RMSE.



5. Mandatory Outputs

A. Forecast Model Documentation

- Modeling approach
- Feature engineering logic
- Handling of seasonality and structural breaks
- Time-aware validation methodology
- Leakage controls

B. Historical Backtest Metrics

Report on Training period:

- Total deviation penalty (₹)
- Peak-hour penalty (₹)
- Off-peak penalty (₹)
- Forecast bias (%)
- 95th percentile absolute deviation (kW)

C. Risk Strategy Proposal

- Bias positioning (if any)
- Quantile or buffering approach
- Peak-hour risk mitigation strategy
- Expected penalty reduction vs naive baseline

Only genuine data inconsistencies may be raised.



Stage 2 – Regime Shift & Penalty Escalation

 28 February 2026 | 7:00 PM

1. Data Release

Dataset now available: **Test Set** (Out-of-Time)

This dataset represents out-of-time load behaviour characterized by:

- Elevated volatility
- Increased intra-day fluctuation
- Altered weekday/weekend elasticity
- Amplified peak-hour variability

This period was not included in training.

2. Regulatory Update – Peak Sensitivity Escalation

Effective immediately:

Revised Peak-Hour Penalty (6:00 PM – 10:00 PM)

Condition	Penalty
Actual > Forecast	₹6 per kWh deviation
Forecast > Actual	₹2 per kWh deviation

Off-peak penalties remain unchanged.

Underestimation during peak hours now carries materially higher financial exposure.

3. Revised Analytical Requirements

You must:

1. Generate forecasts for Test dataset.
2. Compute deviation penalties under revised structure.
3. Quantify:
 - Total penalty (₹)
 - Peak-hour penalty (₹)
 - Off-peak penalty (₹)
 - Forecast bias (%)
 - 95th percentile absolute deviation (kW)
4. Compare:
 - Stage 1 historical penalty exposure
 - Stage 2 test penalty exposure
5. Recalibrate forecasting and buffering strategy if necessary.



4. Modeling Discipline

You must:

- Avoid temporal leakage.
- Ensure weather variables reflect available forecast horizon.
- Document structural adjustments.
- Justify any bias or quantile modifications introduced post-update.

No regulatory clarifications will be provided.



Stage 3 – Confidential Board Directive

 01 March 2026 | 5:00 AM

Following review of Stage 2 results and grid sensitivity concerns, the Board issues the following binding constraints.

All constraints must be satisfied.

1. Total Financial Exposure Cap

Total deviation penalty (under revised peak-hour rates) must not exceed: ₹ X

(Threshold will be defined as Stage 2 baseline – required improvement margin.)

You must report:

- Total penalty
- Peak-hour penalty
- Off-peak penalty

2. Peak-Hour Reliability Constraint

During Peak Hours (6:00 PM – 10:00 PM):

Underestimation exceeding **5% of actual load**

is permitted for **a maximum of 3 intervals**.

Exceeding this threshold materially impacts evaluation.

3. Forecast Bias Bound

Overall forecast bias must remain within:

[-2% ≤ {Bias} ≤ +3%]

Upward bias beyond +3% = over-procurement risk

Downward bias below -2% = regulatory risk

4. Buffering Constraint

Average forecast uplift (relative to unbiased model) must not exceed:

3% across entire test window



5. Risk Transparency Requirement

You must report:

- 95th percentile absolute deviation
- Worst 5 deviation intervals
- Financial impact of peak-hour volatility
- Justification of regime-adjusted modeling strategy

6. Executive Expectation

The Board expects:

- Financial prudence
- Regulatory compliance
- Grid stability
- Transparent trade-off articulation

Failure to satisfy any constraint materially impacts evaluation.

No clarifications will be provided.